



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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**Let's Start!**

Learning about Programming Languages History

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Learning Outcome:

Describe common activities at work to a visitor using short sentences in familiar spoken and written situations.

Give detailed and important information regarding to the history of language programming in different periods of time.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know any interesting fact about programming languages history?
- Are current programming languages different from the first ones? Explain.

Can Do Statements:

- I can give important information related to the history of software programming and its evolution.
- I can give information about the first programming languages in software programming history.
- I can explain key features related to the first programming languages.





Let's Explore!

Mr. Peterson is giving a class about the history of programming languages.



Instructions: Read the text below.

- Mr. Peterson:** Good morning. Since we didn't get to finish last class, today we're going to continue with the topic: History of programming languages. Does anyone know something about it?
- Sophie:** In the 20th century, the first computers used to have poor limited speed and memory capacity. But then, it was discovered that logic could be represented with numbers and not only with words, as it used to be.
- Mr. Peterson:** You're right, Sophie. That's not the first fact we know about programming languages, though. Its history didn't start in the 20th century; everything started in 1890 when Herman Hollerith encoded census data on punch cards. He managed to apply this when he saw how train conductors used to encode the arrival of people; back then, they marked the position by punching holes on the tickets. Now, Sophie, do you think our forebears could forecast how programming would be in the future?
- Sophie:** Well, I guess they didn't think it could ever be so important for us nowadays. Then, what were the first programming languages? Was it Basic Language?
- Mr. Peterson:** No. One of the oldest programming languages was FORTRAN, which stands for formula translation. It was used since 1957 to perform scientific, mathematical, and statistical computations. The key features of FORTRAN are currently used in aerospace, automotive industries, government, and research institutions. In addition, COBOL, which stands for Common Business Oriented Language, developed in 1959 just after FORTRAN. COBOL was designed to be user-friendly and it used to be applied by the United States Postal Service.
- Sophie:** Then, Basic Language didn't initiate until 1964. Created as a simplified language, it was designed for those who didn't have a technical background to avoid making intellectual effort.
- Mr. Peterson:** Correct.



Let's Practice!

Let's check more facts about programming languages.

Instructions: Match column A with Column B.

COLUMN A

1. Most of the people didn't know that FORTRAN and COBOL were the...
2. Basic Language
3. Sophie wasn't in the class when the teacher said that FORTRAN,

COLUMN B

- a. ...the first two programming languages ever invented.
- b. ... wasn't invented in the 18th century but in 1964, and is still used today.
- c. ...invented in 1959, is the oldest programming language.



Let's Practice!

This is what programming languages used to be.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. 20th / that / to / started / in / programming / People / the / used / think / century. / languages

1. People / words, / represented / be / with / used / to / numbers. / could / logic / that / not / with / think

3. the / of / conductors / tickets / track / passengers. / arrival / used / punch / to / to / Train / the



Extension Activity

Now, I can share more information about the history of programming languages.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Look for more information about first programming languages.
- Create a presentation with the main characteristics of first programming languages.
- Show at least three examples.
- Share with your partners the presentation you created.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I look for more information about first programming languages. ☐ Yes ☐ No
- I create a post with the main characteristics of the first programming languages. ☐ Yes ☐ No
- I show examples of the first Language Programming. ☐ Yes ☐ No
- I share with your partners the post you created. ☐ Yes ☐ No



Target Words

- **perform** (verb): to do something
e.g. It was used since 1957 to perform scientific, mathematical, and statistical computations.
- **background** (noun): situation behind any particular event
e.g. Created as a simplified language, it was designed for those who didn't have a technical background to avoid making intellectual effort.
- **stand for** (phrasal verb): represent; mean
e.g. One of the oldest programming languages was FORTRAN, which stands for formula translation.
- **forecast** (verb): to predict a future action
e.g. Now, Sophie, do you think our forebears could forecast how programming would be in the future?
- **forebear** (noun): ancestor
e.g. Do you think our forebears could forecast how programming would be in the future?
- **encode** (verb): to change into a different format
e.g. He managed to apply this when he saw how train conductors used to encode the arrival of people.



Learning Points

Compound Nouns

Compound nouns are words made up, normally, by **two words**. If you add a new word, you will have a new one, but with a different meaning.

Generally, compound nouns are created by putting together these combinations: *noun + noun*, *adjective + noun*, *verb + noun*.

Remember that a compound noun can be a single word, as a word, as two words, or words with a hyphen.

Closed or solid compound words: These words can be a **single** word.

- keyboard
- anyone
- something
- aerospace
- software

Space or open compound words: They are words with a **space** in between.

- home page
- disk drive
- web site
- virtual reality
- search engine

Hyphenated words: These words have a **hyphen** in between.

- one-sided
- follow-up
- check-in
- high-tech
- long-term

It is essential to know that most of the words don't keep their initial meaning.

Examples

- *Since we didn't get to finish last class, today we're going to continue with the topic: History of programming languages.*
- *Do you think our forebears could forecast how programming would be in the future?*
- *The key features of FORTRAN are currently used in aerospace, automotive industries, government, and research institutions.*
- *COBOL was designed to be user-friendly and it used to be applied by the United States Postal Service.*





Learning Points

Simple past Tense in Negative with Time Expressions

Simple past tense is used when you want to talk about completed actions that took place at a certain time in the past.

The simple past tense in negative is made by using the auxiliary did + not: **did not** or **didn't**. When you use the auxiliary **did**, the action verb is used in base form.

Take a look at the following structure:

Subject + did not or didn't + verb in base form + complement

For example:

*I **didn't know** anything about programming languages.*

The simple past tense in negative with the verb **to be** is made by using **was + not** and **were + not** or **wasn't** and **weren't**.

Take a look at the following structure:

Subject + wasn't or weren't + complement

*Sophie **wasn't** very sharp to find out more about programming languages.*

When you use simple past tense, you can also use **time expressions** to specify the moment actions happened in the past. Such as:

- Yesterday
- The day before yesterday
- Last year
- This morning

Examples

- *Its history didn't start in the 20th century.*
- *Well, I guess they didn't think it could ever be so important for us nowadays.*
- *Then, Basic Language didn't initiate until 1964.*
- *Created as a simplified language, it was designed for those who didn't have a technical background to avoid making intellectual effort.*

